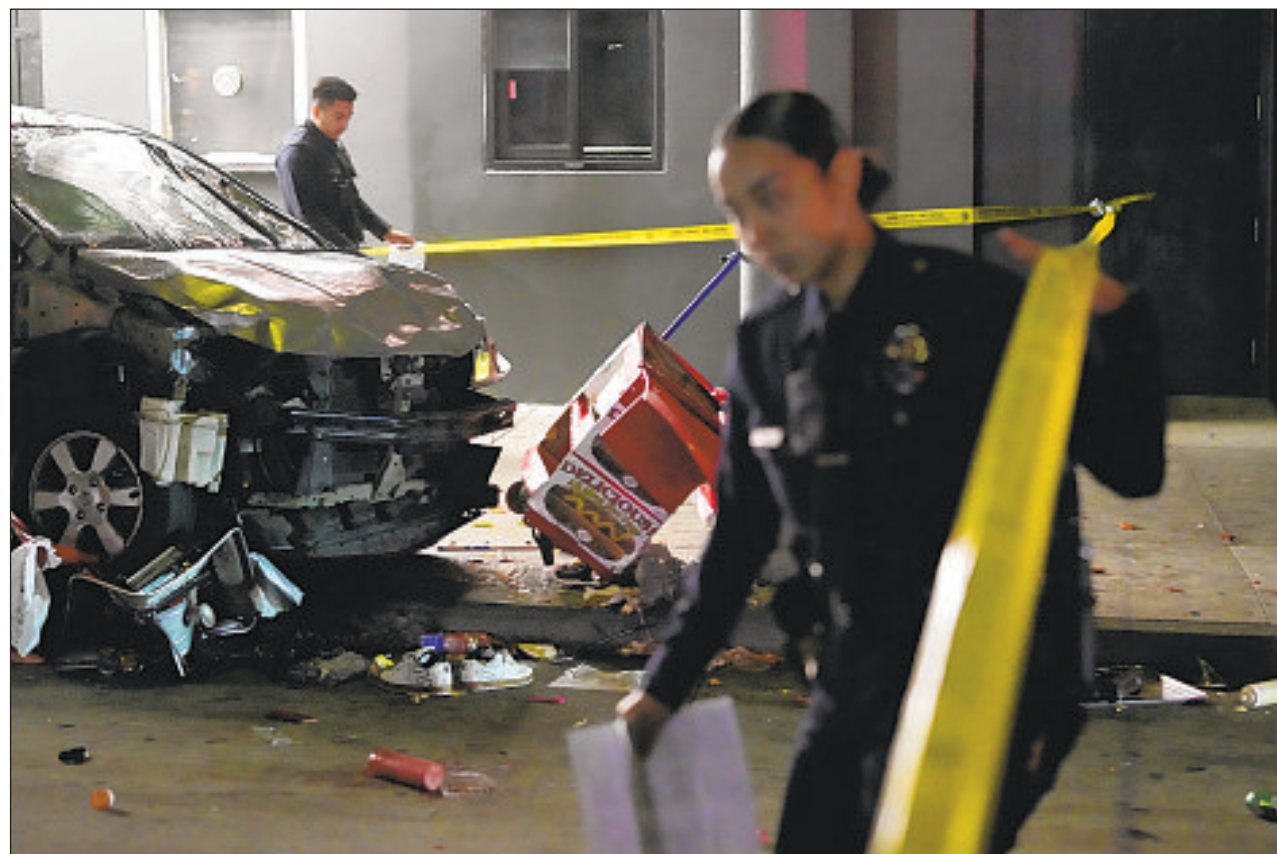




DAMIAN DOVARGANES Associated Press

LAW ENFORCEMENT investigate the scene where a vehicle rammed into a crowd waiting outside a club.

Driver crashes into crowd outside club, injuring 30

Suspect is dragged from his car and beaten before being shot

By RICHARD WINTON, LAURENCE DARMIENTO, REBECCA ELLIS AND MALIA MENDEZ

A patron who had been tossed out of a popular East Hollywood nightclub early Saturday later intentionally smashed his car into a crowd outside the venue, injuring 30 people — seven critically

— before being pulled out of his vehicle and shot by a bystander, police said. The gray Nissan Versa drove onto the sidewalk and hit a valet stand and a taco stand before slamming into a light standard, creating a scene of total chaos among clubgoers who had congregated outside the Vermont Hollywood club. Video taken just mo-

ments after the crash and posted on Instagram showed multiple people dressed for a night out lying bloodied, dazed and moaning on the ground. “He just smacked everybody, bro,” a voice cries out, inquiring of women lying on the ground: “Ladies, can you feel your legs?” LAPD Capt. Ben Fernandes said the suspect was

kicked out of the nightclub at 1020 Vermont Ave. for being disruptive before he crashed into the crowd. “From review of the video he went up to the sidewalk further down and when he hit bystanders, it was an intentional act,” Fernandes said. “He was pulled from the car, handcuffed by security and then beaten by by- [See Crash, A11]

Plan to add border agents faces challenges

History suggests Trump’s push could result in problematic hires

By ANDREA CASTILLO

WASHINGTON — President Trump says he wants to hire 10,000 new U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement officers and 3,000 new Border Patrol agents, but experts and the history of law enforcement hiring sprees suggest the process could be challenging, lengthy and possibly result in problematic hires. The massive funding bill signed into law this month by Trump earmarks about \$170 billion for border and immigration enforcement, including tens of billions for new deportation agents and other personnel. Department of Homeland Security Assistant Secretary Tricia McLaughlin, in a statement to The Times, said that the agency will deliver on the president’s hiring directive.

“In June, our 2025 Career Expo successfully recruited 3,000 candidates and generated 1,000 tentative job offers — nearly double the 564 from 2023,” she wrote. “Our recruitment strategy includes targeted outreach, thorough vetting and partnerships with state and local law enforcement.” During his first term, when Trump called for ICE and U.S. Customs and Border Protection to hire 15,000 people collectively, a July 2017 report by the Homeland Security inspector general found significant setbacks. “Although DHS has established plans and initiated actions to begin an aggressive hiring surge, in recent years the Department and its components have encountered notable difficulties related to long hire times, proper allocation of [See Agents, A11]

California versus Trump: Who wins?

President is taking his policy fights to the Golden State — and it’s punching back.

By KEVIN RECTOR

Six months into President Trump’s second term, his predilection for picking on California has never been on fuller display, turning the state broadly and Los Angeles specifically into key battlegrounds for his right-wing agenda. There are chaotic immigration raids occurring across the state and military troops on L.A. streets. The administration has sued the state or city over sanctuary policies, transgender athletes and the price of eggs. The state has sued the administration more than 30 times, including over funding cuts, voting

restrictions and the undoing of birthright citizenship. Federal officials are investigating L.A. County’s gun permitting policies and have sought to overturn a host of education, health and environmental regulations. They have talked not only of enforcing federal laws for the benefit of California residents, but of showing up in full force — soldiers and all — to wrench control from the state’s elected leaders. “We are not going away,” Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem said at a news conference in Los Angeles last month. “We are staying here to liberate this city from the socialists and the burdensome leadership that this governor and that this mayor have placed on this country, and what they have tried to insert into this city.” The antagonism toward [See Battle, A10]

Sheriff’s detectives were ‘the best’

Three killed in East L.A. blast served 74 years, collectively, in law enforcement.

By CLARA HARTER AND RICHARD WINTON

The three Los Angeles County sheriff’s detectives killed in an explosion Friday were described as the “best of the best,” who served their community with honor, courage and unwavering commitment. The fallen lawmen —



CARLIN STIEHL Los Angeles Times

A FLAG is raised before a procession leaves Biscailuz Center Training Academy after the Friday explosion.

identified as Dets. William Osborn, Victor Lemus and Joshua Kelley-Eklund — combined to serve the Sheriff’s Department for 74 years. They leave behind grieving colleagues, friends and family, including 16 children among them. The lethal blast took place while the men were moving ordnance at the Sheriff Department’s Biscailuz Center Training Academy in East L.A. It marked the agency’s deadliest incident in more than 160 years and sent shock waves through the law enforce- [See Detectives, A8]

Federal cutbacks create crisis for county’s health system, poorest

By REBECCA ELLIS AND NIAHM ORDNER

Los Angeles County’s health system, which is responsible for the care of the region’s poorest, is careening toward a financial crisis because of cuts from a presi-

dential administration and Republican-led Congress looking to drastically slash the size of government. President Trump’s “Big Beautiful Bill,” which passed earlier this month, is expected to soon claw \$750 million per year from the county Department of Health Serv-

ices, which oversees four public hospitals and roughly two dozen clinics. In an all-staff email Friday, the agency called the bill a “big, devastating blow to our health system” and said a hiring freeze had gone into effect immediately. [See Cuts, A18]



ALDO CHACON For The Times

CHANGING COURSE

Swang, an L.A. golf collective, is out to upend the sport and broaden its appeal: no gatekeeping, no country club aura. **WEEKEND, L6**

Harris’ shadow looms over race

The 2026 governor’s contest is in suspended motion as donors await former vice president’s decision. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Medical trouble on the mound

Arm injuries plague youth and professional pitchers, with many relying on surgery to keep playing. **SPORTS, D1**

Weather Clearing. L.A. Basin: 82/64. **B10**



GARY KAZANJIAN For The Times

A MOMENT of prayer as Juan Heredia, center, prepares to search the river.

COLUMN ONE

Diver brings drowned victims home and closure for families

By Jack Dolan

In late May, Joanne Calasanz and her sister, Jomarie, waded into a shallow pool near the bank of the Kaweah River in Sequoia National Park. They laughed at how chilly the water was and dared each other to dip just a little more of their bodies into the cold, clear stream. Then, without warning, Joanne felt a powerful current tugging her away from

shore. Jomarie saw the fear in Joanne’s eyes and lunged to save her. In an instant, the current pulled them downstream toward a long stretch of punishing rapids. “You don’t know if you’re going up or going down, and you’re getting smacked by the rocks like a pinball,” Joanne recalled later. After being starved for breath and [See Diver, A12]